

Soft Skills

Assignment - 1

Q1. Affix - a group of letters added to the beginning or end of a root word to change its meaning or grammatical function. They don't mean anything in themselves alone. Affixes are of 2 types - Prefixes
- Suffixes

Prefix - It's an affix added to the beginning of root word, to change its meaning.

Example - Un + happy → unhappy.

Re + write → Rewrite.

dis + like → dislike

Re + view → Review.

Suffixes - a suffix is an affix added to the end of a root word, to change its meaning.

Example - Hope + ful → Hopeful

Child + hood → Childhood.

Quick + ly → Quickly.

Assist + ant → Assistant.

a 2.

Subject-verb Agreement (concord) refers to the grammatical rule -

- If the subject is singular, the verb must also be singular.
- If the subject is plural, the verb must also be plural.

Rules for concord are -

1. Singular subject takes a singular verb, plural subject takes a plural verb.

Example - The boy runs fast.
- The boys run fast.

2. When 2 subjects are joined by 'and', verb is plural.

Example - Raman and Rohit are friends.
- The teacher and the student were present that day.

3. When 2 subjects are joined by either...or/ neither...nor, the verb ~~with~~ agrees with the subject closest to it.

Example - Either Ravi or his friends are going to the party.

- neither the teachers nor the principal is available.

4. Indefinite pronouns like each, everyone, somebody, nobody etc. are treated as ~~set~~ singular and take a singular verb.

Example - Each of the students is responsible for homework.

- Everybody likes to be appreciated.

5. Determiners like few, many, several, both, some etc. always take plural form.

Example - Few were left alive after the flood.

- Many were against the system.

6. A subject will come before a phrase beginning with "of".

Example - A bouquet of yellow roses lends color and fragrance to the room.

7. Words like along with, as well as, besides, not, etc. are not the part of subject. Ignore them and use a singular verb when subject is singular.

Example - the politician, along with ~~his~~ the newsmen, is expected shortly.

8. Some nouns plural in form, ~~take~~ but singular in meaning take a singular verb. Example - The news is false.
- Mathematics is hard.

9. Use a singular verb with distances, periods of time, sums of money, etc. when considered as unit.
Example - Three miles is too far to walk.

Q 3. Homophones - these are words that sound same as another word but has a different meaning and often different spelling.

Examples -

1. Sea/See.

(1) The ship is sailing on the sea.

(2) I can see a bird on the tree.

2. Right / write.

- (1) It's not right to be rude to others.
- (2) Please write your name on the paper.

3. Flour / Flower.

- (1) She bought some wheat flour.
- (2) Rose is a beautiful flower.

4. Two / too.

- (1) I have two books on the table.
- (2) She is coming with us too.

Q 4. Listening process - It's the step-by-step method by which we receive, understand and respond to spoken messages.

Barriers are factors that hinder effective listening and understanding. Types of barriers -

- (1) Physical Barrier - External noise or environmental distractions (eg. loud construction noises)
- (2) Psychological Barriers - Mental distractions like stress, anger, or

- prejudices affecting focus.
- (3) Semantic Barrier - Misunderstandings caused by unclear language or jargon.
 - (4) Physiological barrier - Physical conditions such as hearing impairment or fatigue.
 - (5) Language barrier - Difficulty understanding due to unfamiliar accents or language differences.
 - (6) Selective listening - Hearing only what interests you and ignoring the rest.

Q. 5 Traits of a good listener are -

- (1) Attentiveness - Fully focusing on the speaker without distractions.
- (2) Patience - Allowing the speaker to finish without interrupting.
- (3) Open-mindedness - Being willing to hear and consider different view points.
- (4) Empathy - Understanding and relating to

speaker's emotions -

- (5) Non-judgemental attitude - Avoiding quick conclusions or biases

while listening

- (6) Providing feedback - Giving appropriate verbal or non-verbal responses to show understanding.